

Where Legacy Meets Opportunity

Anil Somani shares how FOSTIIMA is redefining management education through real-world learning, corporate mentorship, and a vision rooted in inclusive excellence

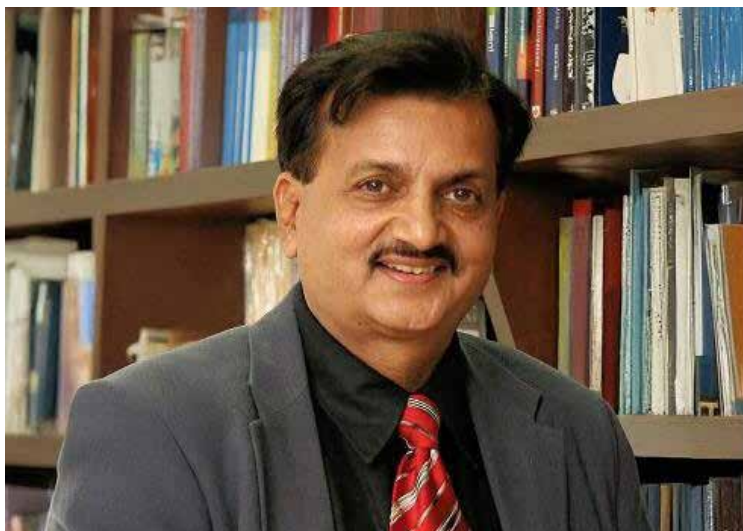
What was the core idea behind establishing FOSTIIMA?

FOSTIIMA, an acronym for "Friends of [IIM-A] Sharing the IIM-A Experience", was started in 2007 by our group of friends, alumni of IIM Ahmedabad. After a successful corporate innings, we were in an exit mode to find something greater to give back to the society. For example, I sold my pharmaceutical company to Ranbaxy, and my colleague Jerry Rao sold his IT firm to Hewlett-Packard, and others too gave up their illustrious careers to pursue a common goal.

As IIM alumni, we were privileged to experience world-class education, and we wanted to share that with students who may not have cracked the CAT but have great potential. At FOSTIIMA, we've tried to bring the essence of IIM-Ahmedabad into a more accessible space. With over 35 IIM-A alumni involved, the curriculum blends academic rigour with real-world relevance, providing students with the tools to succeed in today's competitive global business environment and also prepare for the future workspace.

How is FOSTIIMA making a difference in B-school education?

One of our key differentiators is the 'case method of teaching', which is not just solving problems but understanding the problem itself. Another important differentiator is



Anil Somani

Executive Founder & Chairman
FOSTIIMA Group of Institution

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our faculty. Most of the teachers come from corporate backgrounds rather than traditional academia and act as facilitators to develop critical thinking and decision-making skills. Their mentorship, combined with their vast networks, gives students direct access to a world of opportunities and insights that textbooks alone cannot offer.

Our AICTE-approved PGDM programme is designed with inputs from industry leaders and IIM alumni. It blends academic theory with practical exposure through live projects, internships, and workshops. We offer specialisations in areas like marketing, finance, HR, operations, and business analytics, along with a strong focus on leadership and soft skills. The results speak for themselves — our students are getting placed in top firms like Deloitte, EY, Amazon, and Infosys.

Given the current geopolitical tensions and global economic instability, how do you see FOSTIIMA evolving over the next five years?

India is a resilient economy, and despite global uncertainties, I believe B-school education will remain strong. Technological advancements like generative AI won't disrupt management education; in fact, they'll enhance it. The core methods of learning will stay relevant, while tools like AI will improve delivery and outcomes. The job market for B-school graduates is stable, and placements will continue as they have over the past two decades. At FOSTIIMA, our state-of-the-art campus, innovative curriculum, and focus on digital transformation, sustainability, and global exposure ensure we stay ahead. We're committed to shaping future-ready leaders through experiential and future-focused education.